考前复习 • 第3周 • 语法

Integrated Chinese Books 1–2, Lessons 1–20 • grammar and examples only • ★ = most likely tested / weak last time • 📖 = full page in the IC Grammar Book (Extra_IC_Grammar_Book.pdf)

How to use this
Read every ★ card and say both examples out loud. If you can't make your own sentence with a point straight away, open its Grammar Book page. Practice comes from the weekly tests, not this sheet.

Fix these first (Week 2 results)
time + 没 + V + 了 (L18) • 连…都/也 (L17) • 比 + adj + amount, never 比…很 (L19) • 被 + verb + 了/complement (L18) • V不下, no 了 inside (L17) • Adj + 得不得了 (L19) • 哪儿…就…哪儿 (L19) • and the L20 points: 的/得/地, 把 + direction, 的时候 vs 以后

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1 • 语法 Grammar

127 points

第一课 • 问好 Greetings — Lesson 1

1.1 姓 / 叫 — surname and full name

S + 姓 + surname | S + 叫 + full name / given name | negative: 不姓 / 不叫

Use 姓 for the family name only and 叫 for the full name; both need a name after them and are negated with 不.

请问，您**贵姓**？——我**姓**高，**叫**高文中。 May I ask your surname? — My surname is Gao; my name is Gao Wenzhong.

那位老师**不姓**王，**姓**李。 That teacher's surname isn't Wang; it's Li.

⚠ 姓 takes the surname only: × 我姓王朋。 → 我姓王，叫王朋。 Answer 您贵姓？ with 我姓…, never × 我贵姓王。

📖 Grammar Book p. 4

1.2 呢 — 'And you? / What about …?'

(statement)，N / Pron + 呢?

After a statement, put 呢 after a new person or thing to ask the same question about them.

我周末常常去图书馆，**你呢**？ I often go to the library at weekends. What about you?

海伊莎喜欢喝茶，白莱姆**呢**？ Isabel likes tea. What about Liam?

⚠ For 'And you?' use 呢, not 吗: × 我是学生，你吗？ → 我是学生，你呢？ 呢 needs a sentence before it to make the question clear.

📖 Grammar Book p. 5

1.3 Subject + Verb + Object — question words stay in place

S + V + O

S + V + question word? (same order as the answer)

Statements and questions use the same word order: put the question word where the answer would go.

你**找谁**？——我**找**王老师。 Who are you looking for? — I'm looking for Teacher Wang.

你们明天**考什么**？——我们**考**语法。 What's your test on tomorrow? — We're being tested on grammar.

⚠ Don't move the question word to the front like in English: × 什么你喜欢？ → 你喜欢什么?

📖 Grammar Book p. 5

1.4 是 — 'A is B' (linking two nouns)

A + 是 + B (noun / pronoun) | A + 不是 + B

Use 是 to say who or what someone or something is; negate it with 不, and don't use it before adjectives.

那个穿红衬衫的人**是**我们的中文老师。 The person in the red shirt is our Chinese teacher.

这**不是**我的书，**是**海伊莎的。 This isn't my book; it's Isabel's.

⚠ No 是 before an adjective: × 我是很忙。 → 我很忙。 Negate with 不, never 没: × 他没是老师。 → 他不是老师。

📖 Grammar Book p. 6

1.5 吗 — yes/no questions ★

Statement + 吗? | no 吗 with 什么 / 谁 / 哪 / 几 or A-not-A

Add 吗 to the end of a statement to make a yes/no question; the word order stays the same.

你明天有考试**吗**? Do you have an exam tomorrow?

萨利赫昨天去图书馆了**吗**? Did Salih go to the library yesterday?

⚠ Only one question marker: × 你是哪国人吗? → 你是哪国人? × 你去不去吗? → 你去不去?

📖 Grammar Book p. 6

1.6 不 — 'not' (and when it must be 没) ★

S + 不 + V / Adj | past event or 有 → 没(有)

Use 不 for 是, adjectives, habits, wishes and future plans; for something that didn't happen, or with 有, use 没(有).

白莱姆周末常常**不**在家。 Liam often isn't at home at weekends.

我明天**不**去，昨天也**没**去。 I'm not going tomorrow, and I didn't go yesterday either.

⚠ 不 can't negate a past event or 有: × 我昨天不去上课。 → 我昨天没去上课。 × 我不有时间。 → 我没有时间。

📖 Grammar Book p. 7

1.7 也 — also / too; 也不 = not … either

S + 也 + V | S + 也 + 不 / 没 + V | S + 也 + 都 + V

也 sits after the subject and before the verb (and before 不, 没, 很, 都); it never starts or ends a sentence.

海伊莎不会开车，白莱姆**也不**会。 Isabel can't drive, and Liam can't either.

他们**也都**是英国人。 They're all British too.

⚠ × 也我是学生。 × 我是学生也。 → 我也是学生。 With 不 and 都 the order is 也不 and 也都 (× 不也, × 都也).

📖 Grammar Book p. 7

第二课 · 家庭 Family — Lesson 2

2.1 的 (I) — possession ('s)

owner + 的 + thing

的 works like English 's: owner first, then 的, then the thing owned.

这是白莱姆妹妹**的**照片。 This is a photo of Liam's younger sister.

我们老师**的**电脑坏了。 Our teacher's computer is broken.

⚠ The owner comes first: × 照片的王朋 → 王朋的照片 (Wang Peng's photo).

📖 Grammar Book p. 8

2.2 Question pronouns — 谁 / 什么 / 哪 / 哪儿 / 几 ★

statement → swap the unknown part for 谁 / 什么 / 哪 + MW / 哪儿 / 几 + MW

no 吗

Put the question word exactly where the answer goes; nothing else moves.

谁是你们的中文老师? Who is your Chinese teacher?

你想买**哪**件衬衫? Which shirt do you want to buy?

⚠ 几 needs a measure word: × 你有几哥哥? → 你有几个哥哥? Use 几 for small numbers (up to about 10) and 多少 for bigger ones.

📖 Grammar Book p. 9

2.3 有 — have / there is (negative 没有)

person + 有 + O (have)

place + 有 + Num + MW + N (there is / are)

negative: 没有, never 不有

After a person, 有 means 'have'; after a place, it means 'there is/are'. Always negate it with 没.

我朋友**有**一个姐姐，**没有**哥哥。 My friend has an older sister but no older brother.

学校旁边**有**一个很好的饭馆。 There's a really good restaurant next to the school.

⚠ Never × 不有 → 没有. Watch the order: place + 有 + thing (学校旁边有一个饭馆), but thing + 在 + place (饭馆在学校旁边).

📖 Grammar Book p. 11

2.4 二 vs 两 — two ★

两 + MW + N: 两个人, 两杯茶, 两点

二 in numbers and order: 十二, 二十二, 第二, 二月

Use 两 when counting things with a measure word; use 二 inside numbers, in ordinals and in dates.

两本书一共**二十二**块钱。 Two books cost 22 kuai altogether.

我们**二**月**二**号考试，还有**两**个星期。 Our exam is on 2 February — two weeks to go.

⚠ Before a measure word it's 两: × 二个人 → 两个人. Times: 两点 (2:00) but 十二点 (12:00).

📖 Grammar Book p. 12

2.5 都 — all / both; 都不 vs 不都 ★

(plural subject) + 都 + V　都不 / 都没 = none of them
不都 = not all of them

都 sums up the people or things already mentioned, so it comes after them and right before the verb.

萨利赫、海伊莎和白莱姆**都**在学中文。 Salih, Isabel and Liam are all studying Chinese.

我们班的同学**不都**是英国人，有的是美国人。 Not all of our classmates are British; some are American.

⚠ 都 goes before the verb, never before the subject: × 都我们喜欢。 → 我们都喜欢。 With 也 it's 也都, not × 都也.

📖 Grammar Book p. 13

第三课 · 时间 Dates and time　Lesson 3

3.1 Numbers up to 100

十 + digit: 十五 (15)　digit + 十 + digit: 四十八 (48)
一百 (100)

Build numbers from 一 to 十, tens first and then units; 11–19 start with 十, but 100 is 一百.

我们学校有**九十八**个中国学生。 Our school has 98 Chinese students.

这本书**一百**块，那本**五十九**块。 This book is 100 kuai; that one is 59.

⚠ No 一 before 十 in 11–19: × 一十六 → 十六. But 100 needs 一: × 百块 → 一百块.

📖 Grammar Book p. 14

3.2 Dates — 年 月 号/日 星期

X年 + X月 + X号/日 + 星期X (big → small)
星期一 … 星期六, 星期天 / 星期日

Say dates from the biggest unit to the smallest; use 号 when speaking and 日 in writing.

我的生日是**十一月二十号**。 My birthday is 20 November.

二〇二六年十二月五号是**星期六**。 5 December 2026 is a Saturday.

⚠ Don't use English order: × 星期六，五号十二月 → 十二月五号，星期六.

📖 Grammar Book p. 15

3.3 Clock time — 点 / 半 / 刻 / 分 ★

Num + 点 (+ 半 / 一刻 / 三刻 / Num 分)
S + time + V (time before the verb)

Say the hour with 点, then the minutes (半 = :30, 一刻 = :15, 三刻 = :45), and put the time before the verb.

我们明天**早上八点半**上课。 Our class tomorrow is at 8:30 am.

电影**七点三刻**开始，我们**七点**见吧。 The film starts at 7:45; let's meet at 7.

⚠ Time goes before the verb: × 我们上课八点。 → 我们八点上课。 2:00 is 两点, not × 二点.

📖 Grammar Book p. 16

3.4 的 (II) — dropping 的: 我妈妈, 我们学校

Pron + family member: 我妈妈, 你哥哥
Pron(们) + group / place: 我们学校, 他们班
other things: Pron + 的 + N: 我的书

Leave out 的 between a pronoun and a family member or a group you belong to; keep it for ordinary things.

我哥哥是医生，**他的**车很贵。 My older brother is a doctor; his car is expensive.

我们学校的图书馆很大。 Our school's library is very big.

⚠ Avoid a chain of 的: 我妈妈的朋友, not × 我的妈妈的朋友.

📖 Grammar Book p. 18

3.5 请 + person + V — inviting / treating someone

S + 请 + person + V (O)

The person after 请 is the one who does the next action: 我请你吃饭 = 'I'm inviting you for a meal (my treat)'.

白莱姆**请**我们去他家**吃饭**。 Liam has invited us to his place for a meal.

老师**请**萨利赫**介绍**一下他的家人。 The teacher asked Salih to say a bit about his family.

⚠ The person goes between 请 and the next verb: × 我请吃饭你。 → 我请你吃饭。

📖 Grammar Book p. 18

3.6 (是) A 还是 B? — 'A or B?' questions ★

(是) A 还是 B?　S + V + O1 还是 (V) + O2?

Offer two choices in a question; don't add 吗, and if the sentence has another verb the first 是 can be dropped.

你想喝茶**还是**喝咖啡? Would you like tea or coffee?

你们**是**今天去**还是**明天去? Are you going today or tomorrow?

⚠ No 吗: × 你是老师还是学生吗? In statements, 'or' is 或者 (Lesson 10), not 还是.

📖 Grammar Book p. 19

3.7 A-not-A questions (I) — 忙不忙？ 有没有？

V不V (O)？ / Adj不Adj？ 有没有 + O？

two syllables: 喜(欢)不喜欢

Ask a yes/no question by saying the verb or adjective and then its negative; don't add 吗.

你明天晚上**有没有**空儿？ Are you free tomorrow evening?

这家饭馆的菜**好吃不好吃**？ Is the food at this restaurant good?

⚠ No 吗: × 你忙不忙吗？ 有 takes 没: × 有不有 → 有没有.

📖 Grammar Book p. 20

3.8 还 — also, as well (adding one more thing)

S + V1 + O1，还 + V2 + O2

Put 还 before the second verb to add one more thing someone does or has.

王朋喜欢打球，**还**喜欢游泳。 Wang Peng likes playing ball, and he also likes swimming.

我昨天买了一件衬衫，**还**买了一双鞋。 Yesterday I bought a shirt, and also a pair of shoes.

⚠ 还 needs a verb after it: × 我喜欢喝茶，还咖啡。 → 我喜欢喝茶，还喜欢喝咖啡。

📖 Grammar Book p. 21

第四课 • 爱好 Hobbies Lesson 4

4.1 Word order — S + when / where / how + V + O ★

S + time + adverb + 在 + place + V + O

time can also go before S

Words for when, how often and where go between the subject and the verb, not at the end as in English.

白莱姆**周末常常在宿舍**看电影。 Liam often watches films in his dorm at weekends.

海伊莎**每天晚上都在图书馆**学习。 Isabel studies in the library every evening.

⚠ Don't copy English order: × 我看电影在家周末。 → 我周末在家看电影。

📖 Grammar Book p. 22

4.2 A-not-A (II) — not after 都 / 常常 / 也 ★

S + (time) + V不V + O?

two verbs: double the first (想不想去, 去不去看)

with 都 / 常常 / 也: use 吗

Time and place words can come before the A-not-A part, but with 都, 常常, 也 and similar adverbs, ask with 吗; with two verbs, double the first one.

你们周末**去不去**看电影？ Are you going to see a film at the weekend?

你**常常**去图书馆**吗**？ Do you often go to the library?

⚠ × 你们都去不去？ → 你们都去吗？ Double the first verb, not the second: × 你想看不看？ → 你想不想看？

📖 Grammar Book p. 24

4.3 那(么) — 'in that case / well then'

A: statement。 B: 那(么) + suggestion / question

Start your reply with 那 or 那么 to build on what the other person has just said.

A：电影票都卖完了。 B：**那**我们去喝咖啡吧。 A: The film tickets are sold out. B: In that case, let's go for a coffee.

A：我不喜欢吃辣的。 B：**那么**我们点糖醋鱼，怎么样？ A: I don't like spicy food. B: Then how about we order sweet and sour fish?

⚠ This 那 comes first in the reply, before the subject: × 我们那去吧。 → 那我们去吧。

📖 Grammar Book p. 25

4.4 去 + (place) + action — going to do something

S + 去 + V (O) S + 去 + place + V (O)

If you have to go somewhere to do something, put 去 (and the place) before the action.

下课以后，海伊莎**去图书馆**复习。 After class, Isabel goes to the library to revise.

白莱姆明天**去机场送**他妈妈。 Liam is going to the airport tomorrow to see his mum off.

⚠ The order is 去 + place + action: × 我看电影去电影院。 → 我去电影院看电影。

📖 Grammar Book p. 25

4.5 …，好吗？ / 好不好？ — 'OK?' after a suggestion

suggestion，好吗？ suggestion，好不好？

Make a suggestion, then add 好吗 or 好不好 to ask whether the other person agrees.

我们先去吃饭，再去看电影，**好吗**？ Let's eat first and then see a film, OK?

你明天给我打电话，**好不好**？ Give me a call tomorrow, OK?

⚠ 好吗 goes after the whole suggestion: × 我们好吗去打球？ → 我们去打球，好吗？ Don't add another 吗: × 好不好吗？

📖 Grammar Book p. 26

4.6 想 + V — want to / feel like doing

S + 想 + V (O) negative: 不想 + V question: 想不想 + V?

Put 想 directly before the verb to say what you'd like to do; the negative is 不想.

我今天很累，**不想**去上课。 I'm tired today and don't feel like going to class.

寒假你**想**去哪儿旅行？ Where would you like to travel in the winter holiday?

⚠ This 想 needs a verb: × 我想一杯茶。 → 我想喝一杯茶。 (要 can take a noun directly: 我要一杯茶。)

📖 Grammar Book p. 26

4.7 Detachable verb-object words — 唱歌, 睡觉, 跳舞… ★

V + (了 / Num + MW / Adj) + O

唱 + 英文 + 歌; 睡 + 一个好 + 觉

Words like 唱歌, 睡觉, 跳舞, 游泳, 上课 and 帮忙 are really verb + object, so extra words go in the middle and they can't take another object.

昨天晚上我**睡**了一个好**觉**。 I had a good night's sleep last night.

海伊莎很喜欢**唱**中文**歌**。 Isabel loves singing Chinese songs.

⚠ They can't take another object: × 我想帮忙你。 → 我想帮你。 / 我想帮你的忙。

📖 Grammar Book p. 27

第五课 · 看朋友 Visiting friends Lesson 5

5.1 V + 一下 / V + (一)点儿 — making requests softer

V + 一下 (+ O) V + (一)点儿 + O

Add 一下 after a verb ('just quickly') or (一)点儿 before the object ('a bit of') to make a request or offer more polite.

我来介绍**一下**，这是我的同学白莱姆。 Let me introduce you: this is my classmate Liam.

你们想喝**点儿**什么？ What would you like to drink?

⚠ Put 一下 right after the verb, before a noun object: × 你看我的照片一下。 → 你看一下我的照片。 A pronoun object comes first: 等我一下, 教我一下. For waiting it's 等一下, not × 等一点儿.

📖 Grammar Book p. 29

5.2 Adjectives as predicates — 很 + Adj, no 是 ★

S + 很 / 太…了 / 不 + Adj

question: S + Adj + 吗? / Adj不Adj?

Adjectives act like verbs, so don't put 是 in front; add 很 in a plain statement (it's a weak 'very'), because a bare adjective sounds like a comparison.

我们的中文老师**很**好，可是功课**太**多**了**。 Our Chinese teacher is great, but there's too much homework.

这个房间**大**，那个房间**小**。 This room is the big one; that one is small (a contrast, so no 很).

⚠ No 是 before an adjective: × 今天是很冷。 → 今天很冷。

📖 Grammar Book p. 31

5.3 在 — 'be at' and 在 + place + V ★

S + 在 + place (verb: be at)

S + 在 + place + V + O (place before the verb)

在 + place on its own means 'is at'; with another verb, 在 + place goes before that verb, never at the end.

王朋现在不**在**宿舍，他**在**图书馆。 Wang Peng isn't in his dorm now; he's at the library.

我们常常**在**学校旁边的饭馆吃饭。 We often eat at the restaurant next to the school.

⚠ Don't put the place at the end: × 我学中文在大学。 → 我在大学学中文。

📖 Grammar Book p. 33

5.4 吧 — suggestions ('let's…') and guesses ('…, right?')

(我们) + V + 吧 (suggestion / soft request)

statement + 吧? (checking a guess)

End with 吧 to make a suggestion or request softer, or to check something you think is true; use 吗 for a real yes/no question.

太晚了，我们回家**吧**。 It's late — let's go home.

你是白莱姆的哥哥**吧**? You must be Liam's older brother, right?

⚠ 'Let's…' takes 吧, not 吗: × 我们一起去吗！ → 我们一起去吧。

📖 Grammar Book p. 35

5.5 了 (l) — completed action; negative 没(有) without 了 ★

S + V + 了 + Num + MW + O S + V + O + 了

negative: S + 没(有) + V + O (no 了)

Put 了 after the verb when an action actually happens or is completed (it's not a past tense); if it didn't happen, use 没(有) and drop 了.

萨利赫昨天**喝了**三杯咖啡。 Salih drank three cups of coffee yesterday.

明天我**下了**课就去找你。 Tomorrow I'll come and find you as soon as my class finishes.

⚠ No 了 in the negative: × 我昨天没去了。 → 我昨天没去。 A bare object after V了 sounds unfinished: × 我买了书。 → 我买了一本书。 / 我买书了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 36

5.6 才 — 'not until' (later than expected), no 了 in this use ★

S + time + 才 + V no 了 with 才

Put 才 after the time word and before the verb when something happens later than expected; don't add 了, even about the past.

电影七点开始，王朋七点半**才**来。 The film started at 7, but Wang Peng didn't arrive until 7:30.

白莱姆每天晚上十二点**才**睡觉。 Liam doesn't go to bed until midnight every night.

⚠ No 了 after 才: × 他十点才来了。 → 他十点才来。

📖 Grammar Book p. 38

第六课 • 约时间 Making appointments — Lesson 6

6.1 给 (preposition) — to / for

S + 给 + person + V (+ O)

Say who an action is done to or for: 给 + person goes before the verb, not after it as in English.

王朋**给**我打了一个电话。 Wang Peng gave me a call.

海伊莎**给**我们介绍了一个中国朋友。 Isabel introduced a Chinese friend to us.

⚠ 给 + person comes before the verb, and you can't leave 给 out. × 我明天打电话你。 ✓我明天给你打电话。

📖 Grammar Book p. 39

6.2 要 (I) — scheduled future

S + (time) + 要 + V | negative: S + 不 + V (not 不要)

Talk about something planned or fixed in the diary, such as a class, a test or a meeting.

明天下午萨利赫**要**考试。 Salih has an exam tomorrow afternoon.

星期五我**不**去打球，我**要**开会。 I'm not playing ball on Friday; I have a meeting.

⚠ The negative is 不 + V. 不要 + V means 'don't …!'. × 明天我不要上课。 ✓明天我不上课。

📖 Grammar Book p. 40

6.3 别 — don't

(S) + 别 + V (+ O) | 别 + V + 了 (stop / don't bother)

Tell someone not to do something; 别 … 了 means 'stop doing it' or 'don't bother'.

你**别**告诉王朋。 Don't tell Wang Peng.

那个电影没意思，你**别**看**了**。 That film is boring; don't bother watching it.

⚠ 别 is only for telling someone not to do something; for a plain 'not', use 不/没. × 他别喜欢喝茶。 ✓他不喜欢喝茶。

📖 Grammar Book p. 41

6.4 Time expressions — 上/下个月, 前天/后天…

上 / 这 / 下 + 个 + 月 • 上 / 这 / 下 + (个) + 星期

前天 昨天 今天 明天 后天 • 前年 去年 今年 明年 后年

Num + 天 / 年 • Num + 个 + 月 / 星期

Say which day, week, month or year; 天 and 年 never take 个, but 月 and 星期 do when you count them.

王朋**前天**考试，李友**下个星期**考试。 Wang Peng had his exam the day before yesterday; Li You has hers next week.

一年有十二**个月**，三百六十五**天**。 A year has twelve months and 365 days.

⚠ 'Last year' is 去年 and 'next year' is 明年, never 上年/下年; and no 个 with 天 or 年. × 上年 • 三个天 ✓去年 • 三天

📖 Grammar Book p. 41

6.5 得 děi — must (negative 不用 / 不必) ★

S + 得 + V (must) | negative: S + 不用 / 不必 + V

Say someone has to do something; for 'don't have to', use 不用 or 不必.

我现在**得**去开会，没空儿聊天儿。 I have to go to a meeting now; I've no time to chat.

明天没有课，你**不用**去学校。 There's no class tomorrow, so you don't have to go to school.

⚠ There is no 不得 for 'don't have to'. × 你不得去。 ✓你不用去。

📖 Grammar Book p. 42

6.6 Directional complements (I) — 来 / 去 ★

V + 来 (towards the speaker): 进来, 回来

V + 去 (away from the speaker): 进去, 回去

V + place + 来/去: 回宿舍去

Add 来 if the movement comes towards the speaker, 去 if it goes away; a place word goes before 来/去.

你什么时候**回来**? When are you coming back?

外面很冷，快**进来**吧! It's cold outside. Come in, quick!

⚠ The place goes before 来/去, not after. × 他回去宿舍了。 ✓他回宿舍去了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 44

第七课 • 学中文 Studying Chinese — Lesson 7

7.1 Descriptive complements (I) — V得 + Adj ★

S + V + 得 + (很) + Adj | S + (V) + O + V + 得 + (很) + Adj

negative: V + 得 + 不 + Adj

Comment on how someone does something (well, fast, late). With an object, say the verb twice or drop the first one.

李友写字**写得**很好。 Li You writes characters very well.

萨利赫昨天**睡得**很晚。 Salih went to bed very late last night.

⚠ 得 never comes straight after the object. × 他说中文得很好。 ✓他说中文说得很好。 / 他中文说得很好。

📖 Grammar Book p. 46

7.2 太 / 真 / 很 — too, really, very

太 + Adj + 了 (too … / so …!)

真 + Adj (really — an exclamation)

很 + Adj (a plain description)

太…了 means 'too much' (or 'so …!'); 真 is your own exclamation; 很 is a neutral description.

我们两个人吃饭，五个菜**太**多**了**。 There are just two of us eating; five dishes is too many.

你写字写得**真**好! You write characters really well!

⚠ Don't use 真 in front of 'adjective + 的 + noun'. × 她是一个真好的老师。 ✓她是一个很好的老师。

📖 Grammar Book p. 48

7.3 就 (I) vs 才 — early vs late ★

time + 就 + V + 了 (earlier than expected)
time + 才 + V (later than expected, no 了)

就 means 'as early as / already' (add 了 for the past); 才 means 'not until' (no 了 after 才 in this use).

萨利赫昨天五点**就**回家**了**。 Salih went home early yesterday, at five.

白莱姆昨天十一点**才**回家。 Liam didn't get home until eleven yesterday.

⚠ No 了 in a 才 sentence. × 他十点才来了。 ✓他十点才来。

📖 Grammar Book p. 49

7.4 Double objects — V + person + thing

S + V + person + thing verbs: 给 · 教 · 问 · 告诉

Some verbs (give, teach, ask, tell) take two objects: the person comes first, then the thing.

李老师**教我们**中文。 Teacher Li teaches us Chinese.

萨利赫想**问你**一个问题。 Salih would like to ask you a question.

⚠ Don't add 给 or 对 before the person. × 他教中文给我们。 ✓他教我们中文。

📖 Grammar Book p. 51

7.5 Ordinal numbers — 第

第 + Num + (MW) + N: 第二杯茶, 第七课
no 第 for months or siblings: 二月, 二哥

Put 第 before a number to say 'first, second, third …'.

今天我们学**第**七课。 Today we're doing Lesson 7.

这是我喝的**第**三杯咖啡。 This is the third cup of coffee I've had.

⚠ No 第 for siblings or months. × 第二哥 ✓ 二哥 · 二月 = February, but 第二个月 = the second month (of a stay).

📖 Grammar Book p. 52

7.6 有(一)点儿 vs (一)点儿 — a bit ★

有(一)点儿 + Adj / V (a bit too … — usually negative)
V + (一)点儿 + N (a little of something)

有一点儿 goes before an adjective to complain mildly; 一点儿 goes after a verb and before a noun.

这课的生词**有一点儿**多。 There are a few too many new words in this lesson.

我想喝**一点儿**茶。 I'd like to drink a little tea.

⚠ Don't put plain 一点儿 before an adjective. × 我一点儿累。 ✓我有一点儿累。

📖 Grammar Book p. 53

7.7 怎么 — how / how come

怎么 + V? (how)
S + 怎么 + (不/没) + V? (how come — surprise)

Ask how to do something, or ask 'how come …?' when you're surprised.

这个字**怎么**写? How do you write this character?

你昨天**怎么**没来上课? How come you didn't come to class yesterday?

⚠ 怎么 asks 'how / why'; 'What's it like?' is 怎么样. × 你的老师怎么? ✓你的老师怎么样?

📖 Grammar Book p. 55

7.8 的 structure (I) — Adj + 的

Adj + 的 = the … one (难的, 容易的)
男的 / 女的 = man / woman

When the noun is obvious, drop it: Adj + 的 means 'the … one'.

我写了十个字，五个**难的**，五个**容易的**。 I wrote ten characters: five hard ones and five easy ones.

那个**男的**是谁? Who's that man?

⚠ Keep the 的 when you drop the noun. × 这件太大了，我要小。 ✓这件太大了，我要小的。

📖 Grammar Book p. 56

7.9 Connecting sentences — don't repeat the subject

S + V1 …，V2 …，V3 … later mentions: 他/她, or nothing

Once the subject is clear, use 他/她 once or simply leave it out.

白莱姆晚上复习语法，很晚才睡觉。 Liam reviews grammar in the evening and goes to bed very late.

我认识高文中，**他**是英国人，很喜欢唱歌。 I know Gao Wenzhong. He's British and loves singing.

⚠ Don't repeat the name in every clause. × 萨利赫很忙，萨利赫每天都上课。 ✓萨利赫很忙，每天都上课。

📖 Grammar Book p. 57

第八课 • 学校生活 School life

Lesson 8

8.1 Time-when before the verb ★

S + time + (place) + V + O　time + S + V + O

'When' goes before the verb (after or before the subject), never at the end as in English.

我们**十点**上课。 We start class at ten.

萨利赫**晚上**常常在图书馆看书。 Salih often reads in the library in the evening.

⚠ Never put the time at the end. × 我去图书馆明天。 ✓ 我明天去图书馆。

📖 Grammar Book p. 58

8.2 就 (II) — then, right after

S + V1 + 了 + (O) + 就 + V2　S + V1 + (O) + 以后 + 就 + V2

Say the second action happens straight after the first one.

白莱姆下**了**课**就**去打球。 Liam goes to play ball straight after class.

高文中今天早上起床**以后就**去上课了。 Gao Wenzhong went to class right after he got up this morning.

⚠ 就 goes after the second subject, right before the verb. × 下了课就我去吃饭。 ✓ 下了课我就去吃饭。

📖 Grammar Book p. 60

8.3 一边…一边… — doing two things at once ★

S + 一边 + V1 (+ O) + 一边 + V2 (+ O)

Two actions going on at the same time: 'doing X while doing Y'.

王朋常常**一边**吃饭**一边**看电视。 Wang Peng often watches TV while he eats.

海伊莎**一边**洗澡，**一边**唱歌。 Isabel sings in the shower.

⚠ The subject comes first, and each 一边 needs its own verb. × 一边我吃饭一边看书。 ✓ 我一边吃饭一边看书。

📖 Grammar Book p. 62

8.4 Series of verbs — go somewhere to do something

S + 去 / 来 + place + V + O　S + 到 + place + 去 + V + O

Line the verbs up in the order they happen: first 'go/come somewhere', then what you do there.

下午我要**去**图书馆**看**书。 This afternoon I'm going to the library to read.

你明天**来**我家**吃**晚饭吧。 Come to my place for dinner tomorrow.

⚠ Movement first, purpose second. × 我看书去图书馆。 ✓ 我去图书馆看书。

📖 Grammar Book p. 64

8.5 了 (II) — one 了 at the end of a series ★

V1 + O1，V2 + O2，(还) + V3 + 了 + O3

one 了, on the last action

When you list several things that happened, put 了 just once, on the last action.

昨天我们学生词、听录音，还写**了**十个汉字。 Yesterday we learnt new words, listened to the recordings and also wrote ten characters.

昨天我上午上课，晚上给妈妈打**了**一个电话。 Yesterday I had class in the morning and phoned my mum in the evening.

⚠ Learners put 了 after every verb; in a list, one 了 on the last action is enough. ✓ 昨天我上课、吃饭，还打了球。

📖 Grammar Book p. 66

8.6 的 (III) — adjective + 的 + noun

1-syllable Adj + N: 新课文, 大教室

2-syllable Adj + 的 + N: 漂亮的学校

很 + Adj + 的 + N: 很大的教室

A one-syllable adjective goes straight onto the noun; a longer adjective, or any adjective with 很, needs 的.

这是一篇**有意思的**课文。 This is an interesting text.

我们在一个**很大的**教室上课。 We have class in a very big classroom.

⚠ After 很 you can't drop 的. × 很大教室 ✓ 很大的教室 / 大教室

📖 Grammar Book p. 68

8.7 正在 + V — in the middle of doing

S + 正在 + V (+ O) (+ 呢)　S + 正在 + place + V

Say an action is going on right now; stronger than plain 在.

我们**正在**上课，你别打电话。 We're in class right now; don't phone.

萨利赫**正在**宿舍做功课**呢**。 Salih is doing his homework in his dorm right now.

⚠ Don't add 了 to an action in progress. × 他正在吃了饭。 ✓ 他正在吃饭。

📖 Grammar Book p. 69

8.8 除了…以外，还/也… — as well as ★

(S) + 除了 + A + 以外，(S) + 还 + V + B (same person)

除了 + person A + 以外，person B + 也 + V (another person too)

'As well as A, also B': for the same subject use 还; for a second person doing the same thing use 也.

王朋**除了**打球**以外**，**还**喜欢游泳。 As well as playing ball, Wang Peng likes swimming.

除了海伊莎**以外**，白莱姆**也**喜欢喝咖啡。 As well as Isabel, Liam likes coffee too.

⚠ Don't forget 还/也 in the second half. × 除了唱歌以外，她喜欢跳舞。 ✓ 除了唱歌以外，她还喜欢跳舞。

📖 Grammar Book p. 70

8.9 能 vs 会 (I) — can ★

会 + V = can (a skill you learnt)

能 + V = can (able / allowed / possible)

不会 = never learnt · 不能 = not able / not allowed

会 means you've learnt how; 能 means you're able to, or it's possible or allowed right now.

我们**不能**在图书馆聊天儿。 We can't chat in the library.

我**会**游泳，可是今天很忙，**不能**去。 I can swim, but I'm busy today so I can't go.

⚠ To ask someone for help, use 能 (or 可以), not 会. × 你会帮我吗? ✓你能帮我吗?

📖 Grammar Book p. 71

8.10 要是 / 因为 … 就 (III) — if / because … then

要是 + condition，S + 就 + V

(因为) + reason，(所以) + S + 就 + V

The first half gives a condition (if) or a reason (because); 就 links it to the result in the second half.

要是明天下雨，我们**就**不去公园了。 If it rains tomorrow, we won't go to the park.

因为李友不舒服，我们**就**没去公园。 Li You wasn't feeling well, so we didn't go to the park.

⚠ 就 goes after the subject of the second half, before the verb. × 要是你有空儿，就我们去吧。✓要是你有空儿，我们就去吧。

📖 Grammar Book p. 73

第九课 · 买东西 Shopping

Lesson 9

9.1 要 (II) — want (negative 不想)

S + 要 + N / V (want — firm)　negative: S + 不想 + V

Say firmly what you want, e.g. when ordering or shopping; for 'don't want to', use 不想.

我**要**喝可乐，他**要**喝茶。 I want cola; he wants tea.

今天很冷，我**不想**去图书馆。 It's cold today; I don't want to go to the library.

⚠ For 'don't want to + verb' use 不想; 不要 + V usually means 'don't …!'. × 我今天不要上课。✓我今天不想上课。

📖 Grammar Book p. 74

9.2 Measure words (II) — 件 / 条 / 双 / 张 / 支 / 篇 / 节 ★

Num / 这 / 那 / 哪 + MW + N

件 衬衫 · 条 裤子 · 双 鞋 · 张 纸/票 · 支 笔 (IC writes 枝) · 篇 课文 · 节 课 · 本 书

Every number or 这/那 needs a measure word before the noun, and 个 doesn't fit everything.

我想买一**件**衬衫和一**条**裤子。 I'd like to buy a shirt and a pair of trousers.

这**双**鞋多少钱? How much is this pair of shoes?

⚠ Don't use 个 for everything. × 一个裤子 · 一个鞋 ✓一条裤子 · 一双鞋

📖 Grammar Book p. 76

9.3 的 structure (II) — 我的, 大的, 吃的

N / pronoun + 的 = mine, Wang Peng's

Adj + 的 = the … one　V + 的 = things to (eat / drink)

X + 的 can stand alone as a noun ('mine', 'the big one', 'something to eat') when the noun is clear.

这件衬衫不是**我的**，是**王朋的**。 This shirt isn't mine; it's Wang Peng's.

家里没有**吃的**了。 There's nothing left to eat at home.

⚠ Keep the 的; without it the meaning changes. × 这本书是我。✓这本书是我的。

📖 Grammar Book p. 78

9.4 多 + Adj? — how (big, tall, long …)?

S + 多 + Adj? (多大, 多高, 多长, 多远)

V + 多大 + 的 + N? (穿多大的鞋)

Ask 'how big / tall / long / far?' with 多 + the 'big' adjective (大/高/长/远), not 小/矮 in a neutral question.

你今年**多大**? How old are you?

你穿**多大**的鞋? What size shoes do you take?

⚠ Use the 'big' adjective. × 你多小? · 他多矮? ✓你多大? · 他多高?

📖 Grammar Book p. 80

9.5 Money — 块 / 毛 / 分

Num + 块 + Num + 毛 + Num + 分 (+ 钱)

spoken 块 / 毛 / 分 = written 元 / 角 / 分

last unit can drop: 五块五 = ¥5.50

Say prices with 块 (yuan), 毛 (ten fen) and 分; in speech the last unit is often left off.

这件衬衫**八十九块九**。 This shirt is ¥89.90.

一瓶可乐**三块五毛**钱。 A bottle of cola is ¥3.50.

⚠ If you say 钱, keep the last unit. × 三块五钱 ✓三块五毛钱 / 三块五

📖 Grammar Book p. 81

9.6 跟/和…(不)一样 — the same as / different from ★

A + 跟/和 + B + (不)一样　A + 跟/和 + B + 一样 + Adj (as … as)

Say A is the same as or different from B; put an adjective after 一样 for 'as … as'.

海伊莎的手机**跟**我的**不一样**。 Isabel's phone is different from mine.

王朋**跟**他哥哥**一样**高。 Wang Peng is as tall as his older brother.

⚠ 不 goes before 一样, not before 跟. × 他的鞋不跟我的一样。✓他的鞋跟我的不一样。

📖 Grammar Book p. 83

9.7 虽然…可是/但是… — although ★

(虽然) + A，可是 / 但是 + B

'Although A, B': 虽然 can be dropped, but 可是/但是 must stay.

虽然这双鞋很便宜，**可是**大小不合适。 Although these shoes are cheap, they aren't the right size.

学中文不容易，**但是**很有意思。 Learning Chinese isn't easy, but it's very interesting.

⚠ Unlike English, keep 可是/但是 in the second half. × 虽然他很忙，他常常去打球。 ✓ 虽然他很忙，可是他常常去打球。

📖 Grammar Book p. 85

第十课 • 交通 Transport Lesson 10

10.1 Topic-comment (I) — known thing first

Topic (known N) + S + V (+ 了) 那本书我看了。

When everyone knows which thing you mean, put it first as the topic, then say something about it.

你的衬衫我给你妈妈了。 I gave your shirt to your mum.

今天的功课你做了吗？ Have you done today's homework?

⚠ The topic must be a known, specific thing (这/那 …), not 'a …'. × 一本书我买了。 ✓ 那本书我买了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 86

10.2 或者 vs 还是 — or ★

A + 还是 + B? (question: which one?)

A + 或者 + B (statement: either is fine)

还是 is 'or' in a question asking someone to choose; 或者 is 'or' in a statement.

你想坐公共汽车**还是**坐地铁？ Do you want to take the bus or the underground?

星期六**或者**星期天我都有空儿。 I'm free on Saturday or Sunday, either is fine.

⚠ Don't use 或者 in a choice question. × 你喝茶或者喝咖啡？ ✓ 你喝茶还是喝咖啡?

📖 Grammar Book p. 88

10.3 先…再… — first … then … ★

S + 先 + V1 (+ O)，再 + V2 (+ O)

Give the order of two actions; this 再 means 'then', not 'again'.

我想**先**打球**再**去图书馆。 I'd like to play ball first and then go to the library.

你**先**坐地铁，**再**换公共汽车。 Take the underground first, then change to a bus.

⚠ 先 and 再 go after the subject, before the verb. × 先我吃饭，再我做功课。 ✓ 我先吃饭，再做功课。

📖 Grammar Book p. 89

10.4 还是…(吧) — had better / let's … instead

S + 还是 + V (+ O) + 吧

After weighing things up, suggest the better choice: 'you'd better …' or 'let's … instead'.

坐出租车太贵了，我们**还是**坐地铁**吧**。 Taxis are too expensive; let's take the underground instead.

明天要考试，你**还是**在家复习**吧**。 There's an exam tomorrow; you'd better stay home and revise.

⚠ Here 还是 means 'had better', not 'or': it comes before the verb, and the sentence usually ends in 吧, not a question mark.

📖 Grammar Book p. 90

10.5 每…都… — every

每 + MW + N + 都 + V (每个人都 …)

S + 每天 / 每年 / 每个星期 + 都 + V

With 每 'every', put 都 before the verb and keep the measure word.

李友**每**天晚上**都**预习课文。 Li You previews the text every evening.

这儿**每**个人我**都**认识。 I know everyone here.

⚠ 每 needs a measure word (天 and 年 count as their own). × 每学生都有电脑。 ✓ 每个学生都有电脑。

📖 Grammar Book p. 91

10.6 (快)要…了 — about to, soon ★

(快)要 + V / Adj + 了 快 + time + 了 (快十二点了)

Say something is about to happen or is nearly here.

寒假**快要**到**了**，你打算做什么？ The winter holiday is nearly here. What are you planning to do?

快要考试**了**，我们得准备一下。 The exam is coming up; we need to prepare.

⚠ Don't use 快要 with an exact time such as 明天; use 就要 instead. × 明天快要考试了。 ✓ 明天就要考试了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 92

第十一课 · 天气 Weather — Lesson 11

11.1 比 (I) — A is more … than B ★

A + 比 + B + Adj | A + 比 + B + Adj + 一点儿 / 得多 / 多了 | A + 比 + B + 更/还 + Adj

Compare two things. Show the degree with 一点儿 / 得多 / 多了 after the adjective, or 更/还 before it — never 很/非常/太.

李友**比**她姐姐高。 Li You is taller than her older sister.

今天**比**昨天暖和**得多**。 Today is much warmer than yesterday.

⚠ No 很/非常/太 before the adjective in a 比 sentence. × 今天比昨天很冷。 → 今天比昨天冷多了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 94

11.2 了 (III) — sentence-final 了: a new situation ★

S + V (+ O) / Adj + 了 | S + 不 + V + 了 (not … any more) | S + 没有 + N + 了 (none left)

At the end of a sentence, 了 says things are now different: something has started, become true, or stopped.

外边下雪**了**。 It's snowing outside (it has started).

我**没有**钱**了**，**不**买**了**。 I've got no money left, so I won't buy it any more.

⚠ Don't add 了 to a plain 'didn't' sentence. × 我昨天没去了。 → 我昨天没去。 (不 + V + 了 means 'not any more': 我不去了。)

📖 Grammar Book p. 96

11.3 会 (II) — will (prediction)

S + 会 + V (+ O) | S + 不会 + V (+ O)

Predict what will (probably) happen, e.g. the weather or whether someone will come.

天气预报说明天**会**下雪。 The weather forecast says it will snow tomorrow.

他这几天很忙，今天晚上**不会**来。 He's very busy these days; he won't come tonight.

⚠ The negative is 不会, never 没会. × 明天没会下雨。 → 明天不会下雨。

📖 Grammar Book p. 98

11.4 Adj + (一)点儿 — a bit more …

S + Adj + (一)点儿 (+ 了) | 请 + V + Adj + (一)点儿

Say 'a little more Adj' when comparing or asking for a change. 一点儿 goes AFTER the adjective.

这件太大了，有没有**小一点儿**的? This one is too big — do you have a slightly smaller one?

你说得太快了，请说**慢一点儿**。 You're speaking too fast; please speak a bit more slowly.

⚠ Don't put 一点儿 before the adjective. × 这件衣服一点儿贵。 → 这件衣服贵一点儿 (comparing) / 这件衣服有(一)点儿贵 (complaining).

📖 Grammar Book p. 99

11.5 又 vs 再 — again ★

S + 又 + V + 了 (it happened again) | S + 再 + V (will do it again) | 又 + 是/会/要/想 … (even about the future)

Both mean 'again'. 又 = it has already happened again; 再 = you will do it again (plans, requests).

昨天下雪了，今天**又**下雪了。 It snowed yesterday, and it snowed again today.

这个电影很好看，我想**再**看一遍。 This film is great; I want to watch it again.

⚠ Don't use 再 for something that already happened. × 他昨天再来了。 → 他昨天又来了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 100

11.6 A是A，可是… — yes, A, but …

Adj/V + 是 + Adj/V，可是/但是 + …

Agree with a point someone has just made, then add a 'but'. Repeat the same word on both sides of 是.

滑冰**难是难**，**可是**很有意思。 Ice skating is hard, sure, but it's fun.

这件衣服**好看是好看**，**但是**太贵了。 This top is nice, but it's too expensive.

⚠ Use it only as a reply about a word that was already mentioned. For new information use 虽然…可是….

📖 Grammar Book p. 101

第十二课 · 吃饭 Dining — Lesson 12

12.1 一 + MW + 也/都 + 不/没; 一点儿也不 — not a single / not at all ★

S + 一 + MW + N + 也/都 + 不/没 + V | N + S + 一 + MW + 也/都 + 不/没 + V | S + 一点儿 + (N) + 也/都 + 不/没 + V/Adj

Strong negative: 'not one / not any / not at all'. Countable nouns take 一 + MW; uncountable things and adjectives take 一点儿.

爸爸今天**一杯**茶**都没**喝。 Dad didn't drink a single cup of tea today.

这些衬衫我**一件也不**喜欢。 I don't like any of these shirts.

⚠ The 一 + MW + noun goes BEFORE the verb, and 也/都 must stay. × 今天我没喝一杯水。 → 今天我一杯水也没喝。

📖 Grammar Book p. 102

12.2 多/少 + V — do more / do less

多/少 + V + (一点儿) + O | 多/少 + V + 了 + Num + MW (too many / too few)

Before a verb, 多 = do more of it, 少 = do less of it. With a number it means too many / too few.

做菜的时候**少**放盐，**多**放点儿糖。 When you cook, use less salt and more sugar.

你**多**找了我一块钱。 You gave me one yuan too much in change.

⚠ 多/少 go BEFORE the verb. × 你吃多一点儿。 → 你多吃一点儿。

📖 Grammar Book p. 104

12.3 刚 vs 刚才 — just / a moment ago

S + 刚 + V … | 刚才 + S + (不/没) + V … (了)
S + 刚才 + (不/没) + V … (了)

刚 (adverb, right before the verb) = 'only just'. 刚才 (time word) = 'a moment ago'; it can start the sentence, take 不/没 and end with 了.

我**刚**洗完澡，舒服极了。 I've just had a shower — I feel great.
弟弟**刚才**吃了十五个饺子。 My little brother ate fifteen dumplings just now.
⚠ 刚 can't be followed by 不/没, and the 刚 clause doesn't end in 了. × 他刚没来。 → 他刚才没来。

📖 Grammar Book p. 105

12.4 Resultative complements (I) — V + 完 / 清楚 / 好

S + V + 完/清楚/好 + 了 | S + 没 + V + 完/清楚/好
V + 好 = done and ready

Add a word after the verb to show the result: 卖完 (sold out), 看清楚 (see clearly), 做好 (done and ready). Negate with 没.

小白菜**卖完**了。 The bok choy is sold out.
那个人我**没看清楚**。 I didn't see that person clearly.
⚠ Negate with 没, not 不, and keep the verb and result together. × 我不看清楚。 → 我没看清楚。 × 卖了完 → 卖完了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 106

12.5 Adjective reduplication — 高高的, 酸酸的

S + Adj Adj + 的 | Adj Adj + 的 + N

Doubling a one-syllable adjective makes a description vivid and usually warm or approving. Add 的; don't use 很.

王朋**高高的**，很帅。 Wang Peng is nice and tall, and handsome.
酸辣汤**酸酸的**，**辣辣的**，非常好喝。 The hot-and-sour soup is nicely sour and spicy — delicious.
⚠ No 很 before a doubled adjective, and keep 的. × 她的眼睛很大大。 → 她的眼睛大大的。

📖 Grammar Book p. 108

12.6 来 — 'I'll have …' (ordering)

来 + Num + MW + N | 再来 + Num + MW (+ N)

In casual speech 来 replaces verbs like 要 or 给, mostly when ordering food and drinks.

来一盘糖醋鱼，一碗酸辣汤。 A plate of sweet-and-sour fish and a bowl of hot-and-sour soup, please.
饺子很好吃，**再来**一盘！ The dumplings are great — another plate, please!
⚠ Keep the measure word. × 来两米饭。 → 来两碗米饭。

📖 Grammar Book p. 109

第十三课 · 问路 Asking directions

Lesson 13

13.1 Direction and location words — 上边, 旁边, 中间 …

N + 上边/下边/前边/后边/里边/外边/旁边
A + 在 + B + 旁边/中间/… | place + 后边/旁边/… + 有 + N

上/下/前/后/左/右/里/外 + 边/面 (plus 旁边, 中间) make location words. They go AFTER the noun: 桌子上边 = on the table.

电脑中心在图书馆**旁边**。 The computer centre is next to the library.
学校和公园**中间**有一个饭馆。 There's a restaurant between the school and the park.
⚠ The location word comes after the noun, not before it as in English. × 在旁边图书馆 → 在图书馆旁边。

📖 Grammar Book p. 110

13.2 没有 (那么) — not as … as; 那么 — so (much) ★

A + 没有 + B + (那么) + Adj
A + 没有 + B + (那么) + 喜欢/会/想 + …
那么 + Adj / 喜欢 … (= so …)

没有 is the opposite of 比: 'A is not as … as B'. 那么 adds 'that much'; on its own it means 'so (very)'.

弟弟**没有**我高。 My little brother isn't as tall as me.
坐地铁**没有**坐公共汽车**那么**麻烦。 Taking the subway isn't as much hassle as taking the bus.
⚠ No 很/更 in a 没有 comparison. × 我没有他很高。 → 我没有他高。 / 我没有他那么高。

📖 Grammar Book p. 112

13.3 到 + place + 去 + action — go somewhere to do something

S + 到 + place + 去 + V (+ O) | = S + 去 + place + V (+ O)

Say where you're going and what you'll do there. It means the same as 去 + place + V.

我要**到**电脑中心**去**上网。 I'm going to the computer centre to go online.
我们**到**公园**去**滑冰吧。 Let's go to the park to ice skate.
⚠ Place first, action last — not English order. × 我去看书在图书馆。 → 我到图书馆去看书。

📖 Grammar Book p. 113

13.4 过 — have (ever) done (experience) ★

S + V + 过 + O | S + 没(有) + V + 过 + O | S + V + 过 + O + 吗?

Talk about something you have or haven't experienced at some time in the past.

我见**过**李友，她很高。 I've met Li You — she's tall.
高文中**没**去**过**中国城。 Gao Wenzhong has never been to Chinatown.
⚠ Negative is 没(有) + V + 过, never 不. × 我不去过北京。 → 我没去过北京。

📖 Grammar Book p. 115

13.5 Verb reduplication — 看看 (have a look)

V V (+ O) | S + 想/可以 + V V (+ O)

Doubling a verb softens a request or suggestion: 'have a look', 'give it a try'. With a modal verb, double only the action verb.

妈，您**看看**，我这样写对不对？ Mum, take a look — have I written this correctly?

他想**看看**我的新手机。 He wants to have a look at my new phone.

⚠ Two-syllable verbs repeat as ABAB: 休息休息 (× 休休息息). With a modal, double only the action verb: 我想试试。

📖 Grammar Book p. 117

13.6 Resultative complements (II) — 完 / 到 / 见 / 好 / 错 / 懂 / 清楚 / 会 ★

S + V + 到/见/懂/错/会… + (O) + 了

S + 没 + V + 到/见/懂/错/会… + (O)

Learn verb + result as one word: 找到 (find), 看见 (see), 听懂 (understand), 写错 (write wrongly), 学会 (learn how to).

我**找到**手机了。 I've found my phone.

老师的话你**听懂**了吗？ Did you understand what the teacher said?

⚠ Negative is 没 + V + result, with no 了. × 我没找到了。 → 我没找到。

📖 Grammar Book p. 118

13.7 一…就… — as soon as / whenever ★

S + 一 + V1，(S) + 就 + V2 | S1 + 一 + V1，S2 + 就 + V2

B happens straight after A (one time), or every time A happens, B follows (habit).

他**一**上课**就**想睡觉。 As soon as class starts, he feels sleepy.

这课的语法很容易，我**一**看**就**懂。 This lesson's grammar is easy — I understood it as soon as I read it.

⚠ 就 goes after the second subject, never before it. × 老师一来，就我们上课。 → 老师一来，我们就上课。

📖 Grammar Book p. 120

第十四课 · 生日晚会 Birthday party

Lesson 14

14.1 在 / 正在 / 呢 — be doing (in progress)

S + (正)在 + V + (O) + (呢) | S + V + O + 呢

Say an action is happening now, or was happening at a past moment. 在/正在 go before the verb; 呢 goes at the end.

你**在**写什么**呢**？ What are you writing?

我给他打电话的时候，他**正在**做功课**呢**。 When I rang him, he was in the middle of his homework.

⚠ No 了 with 在 + V. × 他在吃饭了。 → 他在吃饭。 / 他在吃饭呢。

📖 Grammar Book p. 121

14.2 Verb phrase + 的 + N — the person who …, the thing that … ★

V (+ O) + 的 + N | S + V + 的 + N | V (+ O) + 的 + 那个 + N

To describe a noun with an action ('the man who asked you to dance'), put the whole description + 的 BEFORE the noun.

请你跳舞的那个人是谁？ Who is the person who asked you to dance?

这是**我昨天买的**衬衫。 This is the shirt I bought yesterday.

⚠ There's no 'who/that' word: the description goes before the noun. × 那个人请你跳舞是谁？ → 请你跳舞的那个人是谁？

📖 Grammar Book p. 123

14.3 Time duration (I) — V + how long ★

S + V + (了) + time | S + V + O + V + (了) + time

S + V + (了) + time + (的) + O

Say how long something lasts. The length of time (三个小时, 一年) goes AFTER the verb; with an object, repeat the verb or put the time before the object.

我想在北京**住一年**。 I'd like to live in Beijing for a year.

昨天我**看**书**看了三个小时**。 Yesterday I read for three hours.

⚠ The time length goes after the verb (before it only in the negative: 我三天没看书了, L18). × 我三个小时看书。 → 我看书看了三个小时。 / 我看了三个小时的书。

📖 Grammar Book p. 125

14.4 是…的 (I) — when / where / how / who with ★

S + (是) + time/place/how + V + 的

S + (是) + 跟 + person + 一起 + V + 的 | S + 不是 + … + V + 的

The action has already happened and both people know it; 是…的 puts the focus on WHEN, WHERE, HOW or WHO WITH.

我**是**寒假去**的**。 I went over the winter break.

我们**是**坐飞机去**的**。 We went by plane.

⚠ No 了 in a 是…的 sentence, and only for things that have already happened. × 我是昨天来了的。 → 我是昨天来的。

📖 Grammar Book p. 128

14.5 又…又… — both … and …

S + 又 + Adj + 又 + Adj　S + 又 + V + 又 + V

Link two qualities (or actions) of the same thing. Both must point the same way: both good or both bad.

白英爱**又**聪明**又**用功。 Bai Ying'ai is both clever and hard-working.

这个西瓜**又**大**又**甜。 This watermelon is big and sweet.

⚠ Don't mix a good and a bad quality. × 这个菜又好吃又贵。 → 这个菜又好吃又便宜。

📖 Grammar Book p. 130

第十五课 · 看病 Seeing a doctor　Lesson 15

15.1 Adj + 死了 — extremely (complaining)

S + Adj + 死了

A very strong 'extremely' in casual speech, mostly for bad feelings (饿死了, 疼死了). 高兴死了 is an exception.

我**饿死了**，快吃饭吧。 I'm starving — let's eat.

昨天晚上我肚子**疼死了**。 Last night my stomach was killing me.

⚠ No 很/非常 before it, and keep 了. × 我很累死了。 → 我累死了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 131

15.2 V起来 / V起 O 来 — start to …

S + V/Adj + 起来 + 了　S + V + 起 + O + 来 + 了

Something starts happening, often suddenly. An object goes between 起 and 来.

我们一见面就**聊起来**了。 We started chatting as soon as we met.

下了课，学生们**打起**球**来**了。 After class, the students started playing ball.

⚠ The object goes between 起 and 来. × 他们唱起来歌了。 → 他们唱起歌来了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 132

15.3 次 / 遍 — how many times ★

S + V + (了) + Num + 次 + O

S + V + (了) + pronoun + Num + 次　S + V + Num + 遍 + (O)

Say how many times you do something. 次 = times / occasions; 遍 = times through from start to finish (read, listen, write).

我今天吃了**三次**药。 I've taken medicine three times today.

我昨天找了**他两次**，他都不在。 I looked for him twice yesterday, but he was out both times.

⚠ Num + 次 goes after the verb, and after a pronoun object. × 我两次去过北京。 × 我找了两次他。 → 我找了他两次。

📖 Grammar Book p. 133

15.4 把 (I) — doing something to a specific thing ★

S + 把 + O + V + 了　S + 把 + O + V + 完/好/错… + 了

S + 把 + O + V + 在/到/给 + place/person

Say what you did to a specific, known thing (the medicine, my homework) and what happened to it. The thing goes after 把, before the verb.

我**把**冰箱里的菜**吃了**。 I ate the food in the fridge.

萨利赫**把**功课**做完了**。 Salih has finished his homework.

⚠ The verb can't stand alone — add 了 or a complement: × 我把作业做。 → 我把作业做完了。 Don't use 把 with verbs that do nothing to the object, like 喜欢, 知道, 是, 有: × 我把这件事知道了。 → 我知道这件事了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 135

15.5 对 — to / for / towards (preposition)

A + 对 + B + (很) + Adj　S + 对 + N + 过敏

对 + person/thing marks who or what is affected: 对身体好 (good for your health), 对我很好 (kind to me), 对…过敏 (allergic to).

多运动**对**身体好。 Exercising more is good for your health.

你一定是**对**什么东西过敏了。 You must be allergic to something.

⚠ 对 + B goes before the adjective, not after it. × 喝水很好对身体。 → 喝水对身体很好。

📖 Grammar Book p. 137

15.6 越来越 + Adj/V — more and more ★

S + 越来越 + Adj (+ 了)　S + 越来越 + 喜欢/会/想 + …

Something keeps changing over time: 'more and more', '-er and -er'.

李友的中文**越来越**好。 Li You's Chinese is getting better and better.

天气**越来越**冷了。 The weather is getting colder and colder.

⚠ No 很/非常/更 after 越来越. × 天气越来越很冷。 → 天气越来越冷。

📖 Grammar Book p. 138

15.7 再说 — besides, what's more

reason 1，再说 + (S) + (也) + reason 2

Add one more reason for a decision you've already started explaining. Not the same as 再 + 说 'say again'.

我没有时间，**再说**也没有钱。 I don't have the time, and besides, I don't have the money.

我们别去了，外边很冷，**再说**已经很晚了。 Let's not go — it's cold out, and anyway it's already late.

⚠ 再说 adds another REASON for a choice; for a plain 'and also' use 而且 or 也.

📖 Grammar Book p. 139

第十六课 • 约会 Dating — Lesson 16

16.1 Descriptive complements (II) — the effect on the subject ★

S + V + 得 + (很) Adj　S + V O + V + 得 + (很) Adj

S + Adj + 得 + V phrase

Say what state an action or feeling leaves the subject in: 'we played and had a great time', 'so happy he sang and danced'.

我们昨天玩儿**得很高兴**。 We had a great time yesterday.

王朋打球**打得很累**。 Wang Peng wore himself out playing ball.

⚠ With an object, repeat the verb before 得. × 他打球得很累。 → 他打球打得很累。

📖 Grammar Book p. 140

16.2 Potential complements (I) — V得/不 + result: can / can't ★

V + 得 + result/direction (can)

V + 不 + result/direction (can't)

V得 + result + V不 + result?　(question)

Say whether a result can be reached: can't understand, can't finish, can't remember. Mostly used in the negative.

老师说得太快，我听**不懂**。 The teacher speaks too fast; I can't understand.

这么多菜，你吃**得完**吗？ Can you finish all this food?

⚠ For 'can't manage it' use V不 + result, not 不能. × 我不能听懂。 → 我听不懂。 Potential complements never go in a 把 sentence.

📖 Grammar Book p. 142

16.3 就 — only, just

就 + Num + MW + N　就 + person + V

Put 就 straight before a number or a person to mean 'only (that many / that one)'.

我们班人很少，**就**七个学生。 Our class is small — just seven students.

我们家**就**我会说中文。 In my family, only I can speak Chinese.

⚠ Don't confuse it with 就 'as early as / then' (L7, L8). Here 就 sits right before a number or a person: 就七个学生 = only seven students.

📖 Grammar Book p. 144

16.4 Directional complements (II) — simple and compound ★

V + 来/去 (simple)

V + 上/下/进/出/回/过/起 + 来/去 (compound)

V + 上/下/进/出/回 + place + 来/去

Show which way something moves: 来 = towards the speaker, 去 = away. A place word goes before the final 来/去.

他走**上**楼**来**了。 He came up the stairs (towards me).

请大家拿**出**一张纸**来**。 Everyone, please take out a sheet of paper.

⚠ A place word never goes after 来/去. × 他走上来楼。 → 他走上楼来。

📖 Grammar Book p. 146

第十七课 • 租房子 Renting a flat

Lesson 17

17.1 V了 + Num + MW + 了 — so far, and still going ★

S + V了 + time + (O) + 了 | S + V了 + Num + MW + (N) + 了

only one 了 = finished

Two 了s mean 'up to now': the action has lasted this long (or reached this number) and will probably go on.

萨利赫学**了**两年中文**了**。 Salih has been learning Chinese for two years (and still is).

他病**了**三天**了**，还没好。 He's been ill for three days and still isn't better.

⚠ One 了 means it's over: 他病了三天 = he was ill for three days (and is better now). Keep the final 了 for 'so far'.

📖 Grammar Book p. 149

17.2 连…都/也 — even ★

连 + N / V phrase + 都/也 + V

连 + 一 + MW + (N) + 都/也 + 不/没 + V

Stress something surprising or extreme: 'even X …'. The surprising thing goes right after 连.

宿舍太吵了，**连**觉**都**睡不好。 The dorm is so noisy I can't even sleep properly.

昨天的生词我**连**一个**也**不记得了。 I can't remember even one of yesterday's new words.

⚠ Never drop 都/也. × 他连饭不会做。 → 他连饭都不会做。

📖 Grammar Book p. 151

17.3 V不下 / V得下 — (not) enough room ★

place/container + V不下 + Num + MW + N

V得下 = there is room

Say a place or container is too small to hold a number of people or things: 坐不下, 放不下, 住不下, 写不下.

这个客厅坐**不下**二十个人。 This living room can't seat twenty people.

这个书架放**不下**这么多书。 This bookshelf can't hold this many books.

⚠ 不能 means 'not allowed', so for 'not enough room' use V不下. × 这个房间不能住四个人。 → 这个房间住不下四个人。

📖 Grammar Book p. 153

17.4 多 — 'more than', 'something' (approximate numbers) ★

10/20/30… + 多 + MW + N (二十多个人)

1–9 + MW + 多 + N (一块多钱, 两个多小时)

Say 'a bit more than' a number. With 10, 20, 30… put 多 before the MW; with 1–9 put it after the MW (only with units that split up, like 块, 天, 小时).

我们班有二十**多**个学生。 There are twenty-odd students in our class.

这支笔一块**多**钱。 This pen costs just over one yuan.

⚠ With 1–9, 多 goes after the MW. × 一多个小时 → 一个多小时. Watch out: 十多块 = 10–20 yuan, but 十块多 = just over 10 yuan.

📖 Grammar Book p. 155

17.5 Question word + 都/也 — everyone, anything, nowhere… ★

谁/什么/哪儿/哪 + MW + 都/也 + 不/没 + V (no one / nothing / nowhere)

谁/什么/哪儿/几点 + 都 + V/Adj (everyone / anything / any time)

A question word + 都/也 means 'all / any' (or 'none' with 不/没). It goes before the verb, never after it.

我不渴，**什么都**不想喝。 I'm not thirsty; I don't want anything to drink.

王朋人很好，**谁都**喜欢他。 Wang Peng is really nice; everybody likes him.

⚠ Put the question word + 都 BEFORE the verb. × 我不想喝什么都。 → 我什么都不想喝。

📖 Grammar Book p. 157

第十八课 · 运动 Sports

Lesson 18

18.1 Time + 没 + V + 了 — haven't done … for (time) ★

S + time + 没(有) + V (O) + 了

compare: S + V了 + time + (O) + 了 = have done … for (time)

Say how long something hasn't happened. The length of time comes BEFORE 没.

他**三天没**上网**了**。 He hasn't been online for three days.

王朋**一个星期没**运动**了**。 Wang Peng hasn't exercised for a week.

⚠ The time goes before 没, not after the verb. × 他没上网三天了。 → 他三天没上网了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 159

18.2 好 / 难 + V — easy / hard to …, nice / nasty to …

好 + V = easy to V (好写, 好懂)　难 + V = hard to V (难写, 难懂)

好吃/好听/好看 = nice; 难吃/难听/难看 = nasty

Put 好 or 难 before a verb to make an adjective. With 吃, 听, 看 it means pleasant / unpleasant, not easy / hard.

这个汉字很**难写**。 This character is hard to write.

这本书很**好懂**。 This book is easy to understand.

⚠ 难看 means 'ugly' or 'awful to watch', not 'hard to read'. For 'hard to understand' say 难懂 or 很难看懂.

📖 Grammar Book p. 161

18.3 V + 下去 — keep on doing

V + 下去 = go on V-ing

再 + V + 下去，… = if you keep on V-ing, …

Say that an action already going on continues (or should continue).

中文很有意思，我想学**下去**。 Chinese is interesting; I want to keep on learning it.

再这样吃**下去**，你会越来越胖的。 If you keep eating like this, you'll get fatter and fatter.

⚠ Don't put an object after 下去; make it the topic. × 我想学下去中文。 → 中文我想学下去。

📖 Grammar Book p. 163

18.4 Duration (II) — V O V + time / V + time + (的) O ★

S + V O + V (了) + time　S + V (了) + time + (的) + O

When a sentence has both an object and a length of time, repeat the verb, or put the time before the object.

海伊莎每天游泳**游四十分钟**。 Isabel swims for forty minutes every day.

王朋昨天看了**两个小时的**电视。 Wang Peng watched TV for two hours yesterday.

⚠ The time can't come after the object. × 我每天听录音一个小时。 → 我每天听录音听一个小时。 / 我每天听一个小时的录音。

📖 Grammar Book p. 164

18.5 用 + tool / body part + V — do something with …

S + 用 + N + V (+ O)　用什么 + V?

Say what you do something with: a tool, a body part or a language. 用 + the thing goes before the main verb. (From class, 20 Oct.)

我们**用**眼睛看，**用**耳朵听。 We see with our eyes and hear with our ears.

中国人**用**筷子吃饭。 Chinese people eat with chopsticks.

⚠ 'With' a tool is 用, not 跟/和: × 我跟眼睛看 → 我用眼睛看. 抱 = hold in your arms, 拿 = hold in your hand.

📖 Grammar Book p. 166

18.6 着 — lasting states; V1着 V2 (do V2 while V1) ★

S + V + 着 (a state that lasts)　S + V1 + 着 + V2 (O)

着 describes a state that lasts (the door is open, she's sitting) or how someone does the main action: 躺着听 'listen lying down'.

我喜欢躺**着**听音乐。 I like listening to music lying down.

教室的门开**着**，可是里边没有人。 The classroom door is open, but there's nobody inside.

⚠ For 'is doing right now' use 在 + V, not 着. × 学生们运动着。 → 学生们在运动。

📖 Grammar Book p. 168

18.7 被 / 叫 / 让 — the passive (usually bad news) ★

receiver + 被/叫/让 + doer + V + 了/complement

receiver + 被 + V + 了/complement (doer left out: 被 only)

Say something happened TO someone or something, usually unpleasant (eaten, broken, taken). The verb needs 了 or a complement after it.

我的功课**被**狗吃**了**。 My homework was eaten by the dog.

糟糕，你的网球拍**叫**我压**坏了**。 Oh no, I've crushed your tennis racket.

⚠ The verb can't stand alone. × 我的书被他拿。 → 我的书被他拿走了。 Only 被 can drop the doer; 叫/让 always need one.

📖 Grammar Book p. 170

第十九课 · 旅行 Travel — Lesson 19

19.1 Adj/V + 得不得了 — extremely, terribly ★

S + Adj + 得不得了

S + 喜欢/想/爱 (O)，喜欢/想/爱 + 得不得了

Say something is extreme, in the speaker's view: 'unbearably hot', 'absolutely loves it'. It goes at the end, with no 很 before the adjective.

北京的夏天热**得不得了**。 Summer in Beijing is unbearably hot.

海伊莎喜欢北京，喜欢**得不得了**。 Isabel absolutely loves Beijing.

⚠ Write 得, not 的, and drop 很. × 今天很热的不得了。 → 今天热得不得了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 172

19.2 Question words as indefinites — whoever, wherever, whatever ★

谁 + V1，谁 + 就 + V2　哪儿 + Adj/V，S + (就) + V + 哪儿

S + 想 V + 什么，S + 就 + V + 什么

Use the same question word twice to mean 'whoever / wherever / whatever'. Both refer to the same thing; 就 often comes before the second verb.

谁想去，**谁就**去。 Whoever wants to go can go.

哪儿安静，我**就**住**哪儿**。 I'll live wherever it's quiet.

⚠ Use the SAME question word in both halves, and put 就 after the subject. × 哪儿安静，就我住那儿。 → 哪儿安静，我就住哪儿。

📖 Grammar Book p. 173

19.3 Numbers over 1,000 — 万 and 亿

Num + 万 = × 10,000 (三十四万 = 340,000)

Num + 亿 = × 100,000,000

零 marks a gap: 30,006 = 三万零六

Chinese counts in groups of four digits. Split the number into fours from the right: the left group takes 万 (or 亿), then read the rest.

12,345 = 一**万**两千三百四十五 1|2345: one 万, then 2,345

340,876 = 三十四**万零**八百七十六 34|0876: 34 万, then 零 for the gap, then 876

⚠ Don't count in thousands as in English. × 十千 → 一万 (10,000); × 三百四十千 → 三十四万 (340,000).

📖 Grammar Book p. 175

19.4 比 + Adj + amount — dearer by, younger by… ★

A + 比 + B + Adj + Num + MW (+ N)

A + 比 + B + 多/少 + Num + MW + N

Say by how much A and B differ. The amount goes AFTER the adjective. No 很 or 非常 in a 比 sentence.

这件衬衫**比**那件**贵二十块**钱。 This shirt is twenty yuan dearer than that one.

我表弟**比**我**小三岁**。 My cousin is three years younger than me.

⚠ Amount after the adjective, and never 很. × 他比我三岁大。 × 他比我很大。 → 他比我大三岁。

📖 Grammar Book p. 177

第二十课 · 在机场 At the airport — Lesson 20

20.1 的 / 得 / 地 — which 'de'? ★

description + 的 + N　description + 地 + V

V/Adj + 得 + complement

Look at what follows: a noun → 的; a verb (after a 'how' word) → 地; a description after the verb or adjective → 得.

这是王朋新买**的**衣服。 These are the clothes Wang Peng has just bought.

他高兴**地**唱着歌走回宿舍。 He sang happily on his way back to the dorm.

⚠ × 他说中文说的很好。 → 他说中文说得很好。 Before a verb, use 地: 慢慢儿地走.

📖 Grammar Book p. 179

20.2 把 (II) + directional complements ★

S + 把 + O + V + 来/去

S + 把 + O + V + 上/下/进/出/回/过/起 + 来/去

S + 把 + O + V + 上/下/进/出/回/过 + place + 来/去

Say where you move something. The object comes before the verb with 把; a place goes between 回/进/上… and the final 来/去.

小王**把**冰茶拿**去**了。 Little Wang took the iced tea away.

请大家**把**书拿**出来**。 Everyone, please take your books out.

⚠ The place goes before 来/去, never at the end. × 他把行李拿进去房间了。 → 他把行李拿进房间去了。

📖 Grammar Book p. 181

20.3 …的时候 vs …以后 — when vs after ★

V1 + 的时候，V2 (at the same time)

V1 + 以后，V2 (V2 after V1)

的时候 = while / at the time of; 以后 = after. 'When I get there, I'll …' (first arrive, then act) is best said with 以后 in Chinese.

我看见他**的时候**，他正在打球。 When I saw him, he was playing ball.

我到北京**以后**，要吃烤鸭。 When I get to Beijing, I'm going to eat roast duck.

⚠ 'When you arrive, …' = 到了以后. Say 你到中国以后给我打电话。 rather than 你到中国的时候给我打电话。

📖 Grammar Book p. 183

20.4 还 + positive Adj — OK, not bad ★

还 + 好 / 可以 / 不错 / 行

Say something is acceptable but nothing special: 'it's OK', 'not bad'.

那家饭馆怎么样？——**还**好。 How was that restaurant? — It was OK.

我的中文**还**可以，可是汉字写得不好。 My Chinese is all right, but my characters aren't good.

⚠ This 还 is mild, not 'still'. Don't add 很: 还很好 = 'still very good', not 'it's OK'.

📖 Grammar Book p. 185

20.5 Kinship terms — father's side vs mother's side ★

Dad's side: 爷爷 奶奶 · 伯伯 叔叔 姑姑 · 堂 cousins

Mum's side: 姥爷 姥姥 (外公 外婆) · 舅舅 阿姨 · 表 cousins

哥/姐 = older · 弟/妹 = younger

Chinese names relatives by side of the family and by age. Children of your dad's brothers are 堂 cousins; all other cousins are 表.

爷爷 / 奶奶 father's father / father's mother

姥爷 / 姥姥（外公 / 外婆） mother's father / mother's mother (外公/外婆 is more southern)

⚠ Dad's brothers are 伯伯/叔叔; mum's brother is 舅舅. × 我妈妈的弟弟是我叔叔。 → 我妈妈的弟弟是我舅舅。 (The course slide swaps 姥爷 and 姥姥: 姥爷 is the grandfather.)

📖 Grammar Book p. 186

2 · 易混点 Easily confused

C1 不 vs 没

不 = habits, wishes, the future, adjectives, and 是/喜欢/知道. 没(有) = didn't / hasn't happened (yet); the negative of 有 is always 没有.

我不喝咖啡。 I don't drink coffee.

我昨天没喝咖啡。 I didn't drink coffee yesterday.

C2 二 vs 两

二 = the number two when counting, in numbers with 十 (十二, 二十, 二十二), in 第二 and in dates (二月, 二号). 两 = 'two' before a measure word (两个, 两本) and in 两点 (two o'clock).

我有两个姐姐。 I have two older sisters.

今天是二月十二号。 Today is 12 February.

C3 还是 vs 或者

还是 = 'or' in a question (A还是B？). 或者 = 'or' in a statement (A或者B都可以).

你喝茶还是喝咖啡？ Will you have tea or coffee?

喝茶或者喝咖啡都可以。 Tea or coffee, either is fine.

C4 的 / 得 / 地

的 + noun (我的书, 漂亮的衣服). V/adj + 得 + how well / how much (说得很好, 高兴得不得了). 地 + V = the way someone does it (慢慢地说, 高兴地说).

她是一个很漂亮的女孩子，跳舞跳得很好。 She is a very pretty girl, and she dances very well.

老师高兴地说：“你写得很好！” The teacher said happily, “You wrote very well!”

C5 又 vs 再

又 = again, and it has already happened (often with 了). 再 = again in the future, in plans and requests (再说一遍, 明天再来).

他昨天来了，今天又来了。 He came yesterday, and he came again today.

请你再说一遍。 Please say it again.

C6 刚 vs 刚才

刚 = 'just' (adverb, after the subject, before the verb phrase; can take a duration: 刚来三天). 刚才 = 'a moment ago' (time word: can go before the subject, before 不/没, and before 的 + noun).

我哥哥刚从中国回来。 My older brother has just come back from China.

你刚才去哪儿了？ Where did you go just now?

C7 能 vs 会 vs 可以

会 = a learned skill (会游泳) or 'will probably' (明天会下雨). 能 = able to in this situation, or how much (今天不能来, 一分钟能写二十个字). 可以 = allowed to (可以进来吗？ 能 is also OK here).

我会游泳，可是今天病了，不能去游泳。 I can swim, but I'm ill today so I can't go swimming.

老师，我可以用一下你的笔吗？ Teacher, may I use your pen for a moment?

C8 次 vs 遍

次 = how many times something happens (occasions). 遍 = once through a whole thing from start to finish (read, listen, say, write).

我去过两次北京。 I have been to Beijing twice.

这本书我看了三遍。 I have read this book three times (all the way through).

C9 …的时候 vs …以后

…的时候 = while / at the time when (both things at the same time). …以后 = after. If the first action is finished before the second (到了机场…, 下了课…), use 以后, not 的时候, even when English says 'when'.

我吃饭的时候喜欢看电视。 I like watching TV while I eat.

你到北京以后，给我打个电话。 When you get to Beijing, give me a call.

C10 就 vs 才

就 = earlier or sooner than expected (often with 了). 才 = later than expected (no 了 in this use).

他七点就来了。 He came as early as seven.

他十点才来。 He didn't come until ten.

C11 有一点儿 vs 一点儿

有(一)点儿 + adj (BEFORE the adjective) = a bit too…, usually a complaint. Adj + 一点儿 (AFTER) = a bit more…, for comparing and asking (便宜一点儿, 慢一点儿).

这件衬衫有点儿贵。 This shirt is a bit expensive.

有没有便宜一点儿的？ Do you have a slightly cheaper one?

C12 比 vs 没有…那么 vs 跟…一样

A 比 B + adj (+ 一点儿 / 多了 / an amount); never 很 or 非常 after 比 (更/还 are fine). A 没有 B (那么) + adj = A is not as … as B. A 跟 B 一样 (+ adj) = A is the same as B.

今天比昨天冷多了。 Today is much colder than yesterday.

我的房间跟你的一样大，可是没有你的那么干净。 My room is as big as yours, but not as clean as yours.

C13 了 vs 过 vs 着

V了 = it happened / was completed. V过 = have ever done it (experience; negative 没V过, no 了). V着 = a continuing state or ongoing action (门开着) or the way you do the next verb (坐着看书).

我去过北京，去年又去了一次。 I have been to Beijing before, and I went again last year.

门开着，他坐着看书呢。 The door is open; he is sitting reading.

C14 想 vs 要

想 + V = would like to / feel like (softer); 想 + person = miss. 要 = want / will (firmer: plans, ordering). 'Don't want to' + verb is 不想; 不要 + verb means 'don't!'.

服务员，我要一杯冰茶。 Waiter, I'll have a glass of iced tea.

我今天很累，不想出去。 I'm very tired today and don't feel like going out.

C15 在: verb / preposition / progressive

在 + place (nothing after) = verb 'to be at' (no 是). 在 + place + V = 'at, in' (the place goes BEFORE the verb; exceptions: 住在, 坐在, 放在). 在 + V (+ 呢) = 'is doing right now'.

白莱姆不在家，他在图书馆学习。 Liam isn't at home; he's studying in the library.

别打电话，海伊莎在睡觉呢。 Don't phone, Isabel is sleeping.

C16 对 vs 跟

对 = towards: attitudes and effects (对…有兴趣, 对…很好, 对身体好). 跟 = with: doing or talking together (跟…一起, 跟…说, 跟…学).

我对中国电影很有兴趣。 I'm very interested in Chinese films.

我想跟你说一件事。 I'd like to tell you something.

C17 怎么 vs 怎么样

怎么 + V = how (to do something); 怎么 can also mean 'how come?' (你怎么没来？). 怎么样 = how is it / what is it like? (at the end), or '…, how about it?' for suggestions.

去机场怎么走？ How do I get to the airport?

你觉得这个饭馆怎么样？ What do you think of this restaurant?

C18 多: 多大 vs 十多个

多 + adj in a question = how … ? (多大, 多高, 多长). Number + 多 = more than: 10/20/30 + 多 + MW (二十多个人); 1–9 + MW + 多 (一个多小时, 两块多).

你妹妹今年多大？ How old is your younger sister this year?

我们班有二十多个学生。 There are more than twenty students in our class.

C19 一点儿也不 vs 不太

一点儿也(都)不 + adj/V = not at all (strong). 不太 + adj/V = not very (mild). The adjective goes at the end, after 不.

这个菜一点儿也不辣。 This dish isn't spicy at all.

这个菜不太辣。 This dish isn't very spicy.

C20 几 vs 多少

几 + MW = how many (you expect a small number, under 10; the MW is required; also 几点, 几号). 多少 (+ MW) = how many / how much for any number; prices are 多少钱.

你家有几口人？ How many people are there in your family?

你们学校有多少学生？ How many students are there at your university?

3 • 语序 Word order

The slot order

Subject + time (or time + subject) + adverb (也/都/常常/不/没) + place (在…) / with whom (跟…一起) / for whom (给…) + V + (complement) + O

我	明天	跟朋友	一起	去	看电影

我明天跟朋友一起去看电影。 Tomorrow I'm going to see a film with friends.

萨利赫	每天晚上	都	在图书馆	学习

萨利赫每天晚上都在图书馆学习。 Salih studies in the library every evening.

我	昨天	没	给妈妈	打	电话

我昨天没给妈妈打电话。 I didn't phone my mum yesterday.

海伊莎	周末	也常常	在宿舍	做	饭

海伊莎周末也常常在宿舍做饭。 Isabel also often cooks in the dorm at weekends.

白莱姆	昨天晚上	在家	看	完了	那本书

白莱姆昨天晚上在家看完了那本书。 Liam finished reading that book at home last night.

王朋	上个周末	给女朋友	买了	一件衬衫

王朋上个周末给女朋友买了一件衬衫。 Wang Peng bought his girlfriend a shirt last weekend.

4 • 写作 Writing frames (HSK 3 short writing)

因为…所以…	因为下雨，所以我们没去公园。 Because it rained, we didn't go to the park.
虽然…但是…	虽然中文很难，但是很有意思。 Although Chinese is hard, it's very interesting.
先…再…然后…	我先洗澡，再吃早饭，然后去上课。 First I have a shower, then breakfast, and then I go to class.
除了…以外，还…	除了中文以外，我还学日文。 Besides Chinese, I also study Japanese.
一…就…	我一到家就给你打电话。 I'll call you as soon as I get home.
要是/如果…就…	要是明天天气好，我们就去打球。 If the weather is nice tomorrow, we'll go and play ball.
越来越…	天气越来越冷了。 The weather is getting colder and colder.
最后	最后，我们一起去饭馆吃了晚饭。 Finally, we went to a restaurant together for dinner.
…以前 / …以后	我睡觉以前洗澡，起床以后吃早饭。 I shower before bed and have breakfast after I get up.
…的时候	我不忙的时候，常常跟朋友聊天。 When I'm not busy, I often chat with friends.
一边…一边…	我常常一边吃饭一边看手机。 I often look at my phone while I eat.
又…又…	这个饭馆的菜又便宜又好吃。 The food at this restaurant is cheap and tasty.
连…都…	我太忙了，连饭都没时间吃。 I'm so busy I don't even have time to eat.
比…多了	坐地铁比坐公共汽车快多了。 Taking the metro is much faster than taking the bus.
Adj + 得不得了	考完试以后，我高兴得不得了。 After the exam I was extremely happy.
对…有兴趣	我妹妹对音乐很有兴趣。 My younger sister is very interested in music.
为了…	为了学好中文，我每天都听录音。 To learn Chinese well, I listen to the recordings every day.
每…都…	我每个周末都去游泳。 I go swimming every weekend.
跟…一起…	星期六我跟朋友一起去看电影。 On Saturday I'm going to see a film with friends.
再说	那儿太远了，再说我也没有时间。 It's too far, and besides, I don't have time.

Model paragraph • 我的周末

> 上个周末我很忙。星期六，我先去游泳，然后跟朋友一起去吃饭了。我们一边吃一边聊天，高兴得不得了。因为星期一有考试，所以星期天我在家复习功课。虽然有点儿累，但是我过得很快乐。

Last weekend I was very busy. On Saturday I went swimming first, and then I went out for a meal with friends. We chatted while we ate and had a wonderful time. Because I had an exam on Monday, I stayed at home on Sunday and revised. It was a bit tiring, but I really enjoyed it.

Frames used: 先…然后… • 跟…一起… • 一边…一边… • Adj + 得不得了 • 因为…所以… • 虽然…但是…